DELHIPUBLICSCHOOLJANKIPURAM,LUCKNOW

SESSION 2024-2025:PERIODIC ASSESSMENT-III

Subject:English

SET–I

TIME :$1\frac{1}{2}$ Hrs. **M.M. : 40**

Date :_____ Name : _____ Class/SecIX_____

General Instructions:

- **This paper has been divided into three sections A,B and C.**
- **Section A is based on Reading and carries 8 marks. Section B is Creative Writing and Grammar carrying a total of 10 marks. Section C contains Literature questions of 22 marks.**
- **Read the questions carefully and answer them in a neat and legible handwriting.**

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Section A (Reading)

Q1. Read the extract given below and answer the questions (a), (b), (c) and (d) that follow: **8**

I cycled back to the village at about six in the evening, along a quiet, **unfrequented** forest road. During the winter months it was dark by six, and I would have to use a lamp on the bicycle. One evening, when I had covered about half the distance to the village, I was brought to a halt by a small boy who was standing in the middle of the road. The forest at that late hour was no place for a child: wolves and hyenas were common in the district. I got down from my bicycle and approached the boy, but he back of didn't seem to take much notice of me.

'What are you doing here on your own?' I asked.

'I'm waiting.' he said without looking at me.

'Waiting for whom? Your parents?'

'No, I am waiting for my sister.'

Well, I haven't passed her on the road, I said. 'She may be further ahead. You better come along with me, we will soon find her.' The boy nodded and climbed silently on to the crossbar in front of me. I have never been able to recall his features. Already it was dark and besides, he kept his face turned away from me. The wind was against us as I cycled on. I shivered with the cold, but the boy did not seem to feel it. We had not gone far when the light from my lamp fell on the figure of another child who was standing by the side of the road. This time it was a girl. She was a little older than the boy, and her hair was long and wind-swept, hiding most of her face.

'Here's your sister,' I said. 'Let's take her along with us.'

The girl did not respond to my smile, and she did no more than nod seriously to the boy; but she climbed up on my back carrier, and allowed me to pedal off again. Their replies to my friendly questions were monosyllabic, and I gathered they were **wary** of strangers. Well, when I got to the village, I would hand them over to the headman, and he could locate their parents.

The road was level, but I felt as though I was cycling uphill. And then I noticed that the boy's head was much closer to my face, that the girl's breathing was loud and heavy, almost as though she was doing the riding. Despite the cold wind. I began to feel hot and suffocated.

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'I think we'd better take a rest. I suggested. 'No!' cried the boy and girl together. 'No rest!' I was so surprised that I rode on without any argument; and then, just as I was thinking of ignoring their demand and stopping. I noticed that the boy's hands, which were resting on the handle-bar, had grown long, black and hairy.

My hands shook and the bicycle wobbled on the road. 'Be careful!' shouted the children in unison. 'Look where you're going!"

Their tone was now menacing and far from childlike. I took a quick glance over my shoulder and had my worst fears confirmed. The girl's face was huge and bloated. Her legs, black and hairy, were trailing along the ground.

'Stop!' ordered the terrible children. 'Stop near the stream!'

But before I could do anything, my front wheel hit a stone and the bicycle toppled over. As I lay sprawled in the dust, I felt something hard, like a hoof, hit me on the back of my head, and then there was total darkness. When I recovered consciousness, I noticed that the moon had risen and was sparkling on the waters of a stream. The children were not to be seen anywhere. I got up from the ground and began to brush the dust off my clothes. And then, hearing the sound of splashing and churning in the stream, I looked up again.

Two small black buffaloes gazed at me from the muddy, moonlit water.

(a) Give the meaning of each of the following as used in the passage. One word answers or a short phrase will be accepted : (2)

(1) unfrequented (Line 1)

(i) wary (Line 21)

b) Answer the following questions in your own words: (6)

(i) What route would the cyclist take to go back to the village? Why would he have to use a lamp? 2

(ii) Why did the cyclist stop? Where was he? 1

(iii) Describe the person the cyclist met first. Why was he unable to recall his features? 1

(iv) What happened when he cycled on? 1

(v) What did the narrator plan to do once he reached the village? 1

Section B (Writing and Grammar)

Q2.a. You are Eva or Boris, Maria Sharapova's childhood friend from Russia. Write a diary entry expressing your happiness at your friend's success and fame.

OR

b. Write a paragraph on the topic: **Pranks on friends**

Q3. Rewrite the sentences as reported speech:- 5

a. Sarah said, "My head is aching".
Sarah said that her head was aching

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b. Mary said,"I have just got back from New York"
Mary said that She just got back from New York.

c. John said, "I am going to work for a new company next week."
John said that he ..... for a new company the ..... week.

d. He asked me, "Can I come to the meeting tomorrow?"
He asked .....

e. Bobby wanted to know, "Will you be at the party next Saturday"?
Bobby wanted to .....

Section C (Literature)

Q4. Read the extracts given below and answer the questions that follow:- **3**

a. Santosh had to make do with the local village school. So she decided to fight the system in her own quiet way when the right moment arrived. And the right moment came when she turned sixteen.

1. Santosh had to make do with the local school because

i. her parents could not afford to send her to a school in the city.

ii. it was the prevailing custom for girls to go to the local school.

iii. her grandmother said so.

iv. her father said so.

2. When she turned sixteen, Santosh's parents wanted her to ....

3. What did Santosh do when she turned sixteen?

i. She got married.

ii. She climbed Mount Everest.

iii. She threatened her parents that she would never marry if she did not get a proper education.

iv. She ran off to Delhi.

OR

b. Go home, I tell myself: move directly towards home. I enter a Nepal Airlines office and buy a ticket for tomorrow's flight.

1.. The author decides to go home because

i. he is exhausted.

ii. he is homesick.

iii. he has run out of money.

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iv. Options (i) and (ii).

2. The author is missing his home. True or False?

3. The author is travelling from ..... to .....

Q5. Read the extracts given below and answer the questions that follow. 3

a. "What is the use of a statue if it cannot keep the rain off?" he said. "I must look for a good chimney pot," and he determined to fly away. But before he had opened his wings, a third drop fell, and he looked up, and saw — Ah! What did he see? The eyes of the Happy Prince were filled with tears, and tears were running down his golden cheeks. His face was so beautiful in the moonlight that the little swallow was filled with pity. "Who are you?" he said. "I am the Happy Prince." "Why are you weeping then?" asked the swallow. "You have quite drenched me."

Q1. Where were the water droplets coming from?

Q2. What made the happy prince cry?

Q3. Where did the swallow put up?

OR

b. I was about to run after her when I felt a large hand hold me back. It was a fireman. I hadn't even noticed that the street had already filled with fire trucks. I was trying to free myself from his grasp, yelling, "You don't understand, my mother's in there!" He held on to me while other firefighters ran into the house. He knew that I wasn't acting very logically and that if he were to let go, I'd run. He was right.

Q1. Who is referred to as "her" in the first sentence of the extract?

Q2. Who held onto whom and why?

Q3. 'He was right'. Why?

Q6. Answer the following questions in about 20 - 30 words:- **(2X4=8)**

a. How would Egypt be better for the swallow in winter?

b. Name the different flutes that the author mentioned in the chapter Kathmandu?
Japanese Shakkakuchi, Reed neh, Bansuri of hindustani classical music,
c. What does Maria Sharapova like besides playing tennis?
clear flute of south america, high pitched flute of china
d. Why did the narrator feel awkward in his first year of high school?

Q. Answer the following questions in about 80 to 100 words:- **(4X2=8)**

a. What damage was caused by the fire to the house and the narrator's family?

OR

Compare how the swallow spent the winter with that of his companions?

b. What is the poet trying to convey in the poem 'No Men Are Foreign'?

OR

How does the author describe Kathmandu?

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